



Transportation Study

December 2021

Study conducted by Transfinder



Agenda

- 2 Tiers vs 3 Tiers
- Costs
- Efficiency
- Changes
- Other Considerations
- Overall Summary

What's the Difference?

➤ 2 Tiers

➤ 1 High School/Middle School

➤ 1243 Likely Riders

- Less HS students riding buses due to open campus
- Middle School is losing 240+ students to the new BBH Elementary School

➤ 1 Elementary School

➤ 1212 Likely Riders

- Includes KG thru grade 5

➤ May result in a few more buses

- We have 58 buses in our fleet and currently use about 39 each day.
- Being ultra conservative, this may require as many as 47 buses. Internal discussions believe 42-44 is more accurate.

➤ 3 Tiers

➤ 1 High School

➤ 1 Middle School

➤ 1 Elementary School

➤ More runs through the community

➤ Not enough time between tiers results in under utilized buses.

- This happens frequently at BBH due to there only being 30 min between HS and MS times.



How do tiers affect cost...

- ▶ Our goal is to be more efficient and if that results in savings, that is excellent!
- ▶ We believe our shift from 3 tiers to 2 tiers will result in some savings overall.
 - ▶ Why is this?
 - ▶ We already have enough buses. Districts moving from 3 to 2 need to purchase more buses; whereas we already have enough.
 - ▶ We intend to maintain our excellent staff by reassuring them their benefit status remains in tact.
 - ▶ Less hours will result in wage savings; however, we will need to hire a few more drivers which will offset savings.
 - ▶ Keeping in mind that we previously increased the size of our fleet which came at an initial cost.



Efficiencies

- By moving from 5 buildings to three we have some inherent efficiencies.
 - Placements in elementary schools no longer overlap since we have one elementary school.
 - i.e. Student is assigned to Hilton but needs to be placed at Highland or Chippewa.
- The new BBH Elementary by design will have KG thru Grade 5, which will require the most amount of buses for one building.
 - Running a tier for the MS would require very few buses since it will only be 3 grade levels and this results in idle time between tiers.
 - i.e. Driver has a HS route, but doesn't have a MS route, but then is needed for Elementary route.



To Work, We All Need to Work Together!

- Change is inevitable

- Many ride times should be shorter according to the study
- Depot of private and parochial schools may be the most efficient.
- Bell times are changing
 - We do not have final times yet, but the times in our study are close to finalized for next year.
- Traffic...



- HS/MS

- The Middle School Entrance/Exit will be designated for Bus traffic only.
- The Board of Education Entrance will be designated for car traffic only.
- Looking at adding additional exit through old Hilton Property

- New BBH Elementary

- Oakes Road is designated for car traffic only.
- Valley Parkway is designated for Bus traffic only.



Other Considerations



- The current 3 tier really isn't a true 3 tiered structure.
 - True 3 tier would utilize the same number of buses at all 3 tiers.
 - We are unable to achieve this given current contract language with
- Labor agreements were recently negotiated to align schedules to achieve this option.
- Benefits for families
 - HS/MS students ride at the same time.
- One Elementary instead of 3
 - This is the driving force behind the current proposal.
- Sharing of staff between the HS and MS is more efficient.
- Students in the MS have opportunity to attend class at the HS possibly



In Summary

- After a thorough study by Transfinder, we believe our community is best served by moving from 3 tiers to 2 tiers because...
 - Some cost savings
 - More efficient (and efficiencies may continue with time)
 - Do not need to purchase additional buses.
 - Ridership has changed post COVID.
 - Many are being driven to school and this trend may continue
 - As long as the High School remains Open Campus, ridership has drastically reduced and would continue to stay low.
- What if this doesn't work?
 - While all change may possibly result in hiccups, if the plan simply won't work, we resort to the back up plan...
 - Modify start times and pivot to 3 tiers.
 - Next year begins after labor day. We should know within a few weeks if this will work (we believe it will!).